Fantine XIAO

Erasmus School of Economics,
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Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Experimental Economics, Gender Economics

Placement Contacts

Placement Director: Eric Bartelsman e.j.bartelsman@vu.nl
Placement Assistant: Christina Månsson c.mansson@tinbergen.nl

References

Chen Li	Erasmus School of Economics	c.li@ese.eur.nl
Peter P. Wakker	Erasmus School of Economics	wakker@ese.eur.nl
Astrid Hopfensitz	Emlyon Business School & GATE Lab	hopfensitz@em-lyon.com

Education

Erasmus University Rotterdam & Tinbergen Institute *2023 - Present*
PhD Candidate in Economics *Rotterdam, the Netherlands*
Advisors: Dr. Anne Boring and Prof. Chen Li

GATE-Lab, Lyon *Sep–Nov 2026*
Visiting PhD *Lyon, France*
Host: Prof. Astrid Hopfensitz

Tinbergen Institute *2021-2023*
MPhil in Economics *Amsterdam, the Netherlands*

Ludwig Maximilian University of Munich *2019-2021*
MPhil in Quantitative Economics (Completed Courses) *Munich, Germany*

University of Hong Kong *2014-2019*
B.Sc. in Economics and Finance, Minor in Mathematics *Hong Kong SAR*

Working Papers

Telling You How I Would Feel: Emotional Communication and Ambiguity in Trust

Job Market Paper (single-authored)

Trust requires engaging with ambiguity about others' reciprocity. Emotional communication may shape how people perceive and evaluate this ambiguity, yet many social environments constrain emotional expression. This paper examines whether communicating anticipated feelings affects willingness to trust. It considers three channels using the incentivized belief hedge method: belief, ambiguity aversion, and ambiguity-generated insensitivity. In a preregistered modified trust game, 400 U.S.-based Prolific participants are randomly assigned to one of four conditions: no message, happy message, disappointed message, or a choice between the two. Overall, emotional communication modestly increases expected returns but does not significantly affect trust or actual returns. Its effects on attitudes vary by emotion: happiness message increases ambiguity seeking, while disappointment message reduces a-insensitivity. These findings show that structured anticipated-emotion messages reshape how people perceive and evaluate ambiguity surrounding trust.

Anger as Signal: Decomposing the Affective, Inferential, and Ambiguity Channels in Negotiation

with David Gonzalez-Jimenez and Chen Li

Emotional expressions in negotiation, such as anger expressions, can influence strategic behavior, but the underlying mechanisms remain unclear. This paper develops a structural behavioral framework and uses an online experiment (N = 800) with a 2×2 between-subjects design varying the counterpart's anger expression and gender. We find that anger expressions have no significant overall effect on final offers because they reduce altruism while increasing beliefs about the counterpart's reservation price, with these two channels largely offsetting each other. Anger expressions also reduce perceived social ambiguity, especially when expressed by male counterparts, suggesting that male anger expressions are perceived as more diagnostic signals in negotiation.

Work in Progress

The Necessity to Reconcile Choice Inconsistencies and the Dangers to Do It Mechanistically
with Chen Li, Julia Rose and Peter Wakker

Conference and Workshop Presentations

International Meeting on Experimental and Behavioural Social Sciences *July 2026*
Prague, Czech Republic

Foundations of Utility and Risk (FUR) *June 2026*
Alicante, Spain

EER Summer School in Behavioral and Experimental Economics *June 2026*
Poster session, Lisbon, Portugal

Bayesian Peternalism Workshop *May 2026*
Rotterdam, the Netherlands

Seminars

Behavioral and Experimental Economics Research Seminar (BEERS) *September 2026*
GATE-Lab, Lyon

PhD Lunch Seminar *May 2026*
Erasmus School of Economics, EUR

Behavioral, Organization and Market Seminar *February 2026*
Erasmus School of Economics, EUR

Behavioral Group Meeting *October 2025*
Erasmus School of Economics, EUR

Teaching Experience

Erasmus University Rotterdam

2024-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor, Year 3)	Lecturer
2023/2024 Experimental Economics (Master's)	Lecturer
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor, Year 3)	Lecturer
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Master's Theses x 12)	Supervisor
2023-2026 Behavioral Economics (Bachelor's Theses x 14)	Supervisor

Tinbergen Institute

2022/2023 Microeconomics I: Individual Decision Making (Master's)	Teaching Assistant
2022/2023 Microeconomics II: Game Theory (Master's)	Teaching Assistant

University of Hong Kong

2018/2019 Economic Development of China (Bachelor's)	Teaching Assistant